

C Programming

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Validation Of User Input In C

Basic Rules

- Don't pass invalid data onwards.
- Validate data at input time.
- Always give the user meaningful feedback
- Tell the user what you expect to read as input

```
/* example one, a simple continue statement */
#include <stdio.h>
#include <ctype.h>

main()
{
    int    valid_input;    /* when 1, data is valid and loop is exited */
    char    user_input;    /* handles user input, single character menu choi

    valid_input = 0;
    while( valid_input == 0 ) {
        printf("Continue (Y/N)?\n");
        scanf(" %c", &user_input );
        user_input = toupper( user_input );
        if((user_input == 'Y') || (user_input == 'N') )    valid_input = 1;
        else    printf("\007Error: Invalid choice\n");
    }
}
```

Sample Program Output

```
Continue (Y/N)?
b
Error: Invalid Choice
Continue (Y/N)?
N
```

```
/* example two, getting and validating choices */
#include <stdio.h>
#include <ctype.h>

main()
{
    int    exit_flag = 0, valid_choice;
    char    menu_choice;

    while( exit_flag == 0 ) {
        valid_choice = 0;
        while( valid_choice == 0 ) {
```

```

printf("\nC = Copy File\nE = Exit\nM = Move File\n");
printf("Enter choice:\n");
scanf(" %c", &menu_choice );
if((menu_choice=='C') || (menu_choice=='E') || (menu_choi
    valid_choice = 1;
else
    printf("\007Error. Invalid menu choice selected.\n");
}
switch( menu_choice ) {
    case 'C' : .....();    break;
    case 'E' : exit_flag = 1; break;
    case 'M' : .....();    break;
    default : printf("Error--- Should not occur.\n"); break;
}
}
}

```

Sample Program Output

```

C = Copy File
E = Exit
M = Move File
Enter choice:
X
Error. Invalid menu choice selected.
C = Copy File
E = Exit
M = Move File
Enter choice:
E

```

[Other validation examples](#)

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